peace and happiness does open up contradictions—a tipping of the hat to both the ego and the ideal soul steeped in humility. Thus, while popular spiritual videos talk about 'giving', others stress about 'not being taken for granted'. In a transactional world, followers think generosity should be undertaken only when there are expectations of equal returns—thus flouting one of spirituality's basic tenets.

HOW DEEP IS YOUR KARMA?

The quick-fix nature of online spirituality is something many of its consumers are aware of. "I constantly worry about how the world perceives me," says 34-year-old Neha Bansal from Delhi, a sales executive. "When I watch a clip about learning to be your own person, I feel better. I know that I need to work hard on myself to achieve such a change. Till I am there, this helps."

According to Sri Sri Ravi Shankar, the cycle of short-term relief followed by unhappiness happens when one believes happiness to be a product of some action, event or person. "When you realise that happiness is your innate nature, nothing will make you happy or unhappy. However, this realisation takes time,"

> I get ideas from life around me. **I receive messages from followers saying my content makes them** feel less lonely
>
> **-DIVIJA BHASIN**
> *Emotional Influencer*



POSTS OF THE MOST POPULAR GURUS

SADHGURU



The most followed influencer, Sadhguru invests in a variety of content relevant to modern life. This includes what to eat, how to think, how to handle office stress, even how to have fun

10 million followers

SRI SRI RAVI SHANKAR



To make traditional concepts interesting, he posts short videos like 'rapid fire on Ramayana', 'this is why you are single', 'amazing biohack for computer workers'

1.9 million followers

JAY SHETTY



A former monk, Jay Shetty is the go-to guru for tips on self-care, being positive and finding inner balance

14 million followers

GAUR GOPAL DAS



He follows up videos with short write-ups, many of them focus on the unfairness, mistakes and challenges everyone faces in daily life and how to heal your mind from them

7 million followers

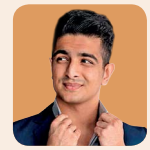
SANDEEP MAHESHWARI



His videos address topics like parenting, failed relationships and self-pity. Answers are given using his or someone else's lived experiences

4.7 million followers

RANVEER ALLAHBADIA



Calling himself 'the friendliest harami' in the world, he posts about meditation, karma, joy and peace, and often has other people featured on his podcast, including Jay Shetty, Kareena Kapoor Khan, Sunil Shetty and Shikhar Dhawan

2.4 million followers